

sense because administrators are employed in companies with operations that are beyond the IT domain—like banks, hospitals or schools. However, it might be a little difficult for recruiters from non-IT organisations to evaluate or gauge the skillsets and technical competency of candidates that they might be recruiting as administrators, especially in current times where FOSS technology awareness in the non-IT sectors is still low,” adds Chandrashekhar.

A Mani from ILUG Chennai says, “Certifications can help in situations where employers want to employ people in order to demonstrate the existence of an IT infrastructure in their organisation. In these situations, ‘otherwise under-qualified’ but ‘certified’ people can be paid less for more work. Competence may not come into the picture and certifications can have just a face value. It happens in private universities.”

Another member of ILUG-C, Suraj Kumar, who has worked at Yahoo!, Amazon and InMobi, and has been doing business with many start-ups in the Internet space as a talent sourcing consultant feels that companies powered with open source give preference to those who are self-learners rather than those who are certified. “I can also vouch for the validity of this policy, because typically, we’ve found that engineers whose resumes have a certification logo tend to have shallow skills. Most companies these days are also beginning to be open about what they look for in a person when hiring—they don’t care if someone has a B.E. degree or not, nor do they care if the candidates cleared their exams. What they really care about is, “Can you think and can you actually do things?”

What the hiring managers have to say

We then went on to ask some industry heads to share their thoughts on the subject. Satish Gidugu, CTO, redBus, a company that has 60 per cent of its staff as open source professionals, says, “Personally, I do not believe in certification. There are lots of talented people who do not essentially choose to go in for certification. I have a perfect blend of certified and non-certified open source experts in my team and all are doing well. I don’t look at certification as a must-have in the recruitment landscape. What matters is aptitude and oral understanding. While hiring, we look at engineers who are more adaptive.”

Vibhore Sharma, CTO, Naukri.com, says certifications do not top his firm’s priority list when it comes to hiring FOSS professionals. “In my opinion, certifications only help when you have a hands-on experience in the open source domain. So, a candidate who has a healthy mix of both, features high on our wish-list. And that has to be backed with the right set of skills,” he says.

So, while we bring you the thoughts of the open source community on what they think on FOSS related certifications, the final verdict is always yours. **END** 

By Priyanka Sarkar

The author is a member of the editorial team. She loves to weave in and out the little nuances of life and scribble her thoughts and experiences in her personal blog.



Please

Tell us!

**Your Opinion
Will Help
us Improve!**



Customer Feedback Form

1. How do you get your magazine?

☐ I am a subscriber
☐ I buy it from news-stand
☐ I borrow it
2. When do you usually receive your copy?

☐ By 7th of each month
☐ By 15th of each month
☐ After 15th of each month
3. How many issues do you miss in a year?

☐ 1 or 2 copies
☐ 3 to 5 copies
☐ 6 or more copies
4. How many times you get your copy of the magazine but not the accompanying CD (if subscribed)?

☐ Never
☐ Once or twice in a year
☐ More than 3 times in a year
5. For any missed issues or CD, what do you do?

☐ I send a reminder
☐ I don't bother to remind
6. On reminding, how long does it take for replacement(s) to reach you?

☐ It takes around a week
☐ I get it within 15 days
☐ I get it only after a long delay or never
7. What is the condition of the magazine and CD, at the time of receipt?

☐ I find them in a very good condition
☐ I find them in a fairly good condition
☐ I usually find them in a poor condition
8. How do you find the price of the magazine?

☐ High
☐ Just right
☐ Low
9. How informative/valuable do you find the contents of the magazine?

☐ I find them to be good
☐ I find them satisfactory
☐ I find them of poor quality
10. How will you rate the customer support system of EPF?

☐ Good
☐ Satisfactory
☐ Poor

Any other suggestions to help us serve you better? (Please enclose)

Name _____ Address _____

Email ID _____ Phone No. _____

Date _____ Signature _____

You can mail us at csyed@india.com. You can send this form to
 "The Editor" - D-87/1, Okhla Industrial Area, Phase-1, New Delhi-20, Phone No. 011-26819601/02/03, Fax: 011-26817563